

IOSCO/MR/12/2026
Madrid, 21 May 2026

IOSCO publishes Reports on the evolution of Market Liquidity during the Trading Day for equity markets and on Extended Trading Hours for equity venues

The International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO) published today its [Consultation Report regarding Regulatory Considerations and Good Practices on the Evolution of Market Liquidity during the Trading Day](#) and its [Report on Extended Trading Hours](#).

IOSCO is seeking feedback on its [Consultation Report on the Evolution of Market Liquidity during the Trading Day](#). Equity market structures continue to evolve, with technological developments and trading strategies contributing, in many jurisdictions, to a growing concentration of **trading activities at the close**. While deeper closing auctions may support price discovery and efficiency, they may also introduce risks, including reduced liquidity during continuous trading, increased susceptibility to market manipulation, heightened volatility around the close, and operational and resilience challenges for trading venues.

The consultation report presents the findings of a global stocktake conducted by IOSCO, drawing primarily on input from regulators and engagement with trading venues. It analyses how liquidity is distributed throughout the trading day, the implications of evolving liquidity patterns and **auction designs**, and the effectiveness of existing regulatory and supervisory approaches. Based on this analysis, IOSCO proposes a set of good practices intended to assist regulators and trading venues in preserving fair, orderly and resilient equity markets as trading patterns evolve.

Separately, interest in **extending trading hours** beyond traditional sessions, including overnight or near-continuous trading, has been growing in some jurisdictions. The [Report on Extended Trading Hours](#) reviews proposals and practices relating to equity markets across IOSCO jurisdictions and examines their potential benefits and risks. It finds that trading outside core trading hours varies across jurisdictions and remains predominantly **retail-driven**, with

limited institutional participation. Where introduced, extended trading hours is typically **venue-led**, upon the demand of market participants, and is characterised by **lower liquidity**, **wider bid-ask spreads** and adjusted execution conditions compared with regular trading hours.

The report also highlights that regulators have largely focused on assessing whether **existing regulatory frameworks** for market integrity, disclosure, surveillance, and operational resilience, are sufficient to address extended trading hours, rather than introducing bespoke regulatory regimes. Trading venues have considered risk controls and operational arrangements to mitigate lower liquidity and execution risk, while **operational capacity**, **staffing**, **post-trade processing** and the transition to **shorter settlement cycles** have emerged as key practical considerations.

This report focuses on equity trading, and IOSCO does not exclude further work on related areas impacted by the emerging practice, such as asset management, valuations, risk management or derivatives, etc.

Comments on the [Consultation Report regarding Regulatory Considerations and Good Practices on the Evolution of Market Liquidity during the Trading Day](#) may be submitted using this [form](#) on or before **21 August 2026**.

If you require technical assistance on completing the survey, please contact itsupport@iosco.org.

If you have questions about the content of the report or the consultation, please contact ML2026-consultation@iosco.org.

“International markets are evolving in ways that call for careful, up-to-date assessment and international dialogue. Through these publications, IOSCO is supporting a shared understanding of developments that may affect how markets function over the course of the trading day. The consultation on intraday liquidity is a good opportunity for stakeholders to inform IOSCO’s consideration of whether existing regulatory and supervisory approaches remain fit for purpose as market practices continue to change.”

Jean-Paul Servais, IOSCO Board Chair

“Interest in extended trading hours is rising in some markets, and the report provides a factual assessment of current practices, observed market conditions and key

regulatory issues, relating to equity markets. In parallel, the consultation on the evolution of market liquidity during the trading day responds to the increasing concentration of trading at the close and seeks feedback on proposed good practices aimed at supporting fair, orderly and resilient markets. “

Martina Tambucci, Chair of IOSCO's Committee on Regulation of Secondary Markets, Head of International Relations Unit, Commissione Nazionale per le Società e la Borsa, Italy

Notes to Editors

1. IOSCO is the leading international policy forum for securities regulators and the global standard setter for financial markets regulation. It develops, implements and promotes adherence to internationally recognized standards for financial markets regulation and works closely with other international organizations on the global regulatory reform agenda.
2. The Organization's membership regulates more than 99% of the world's securities markets in over 130 jurisdictions. By providing high quality technical assistance, education, and training, IOSCO supports its members to come together to achieve the following three objectives:
 - Enhance investor protection;
 - Ensure markets are fair and efficient; and
 - Promote financial stability by reducing systemic risk.
3. The IOSCO Board is the governing and standard-setting body of IOSCO and is made up of 35 securities regulators. Mr. Jean-Paul Servais, the Chair of Belgium's Financial Services and Markets Authority (FSMA), is the Chair of the IOSCO Board. Dr. Islam Azzam, Executive Chairman, Financial Regulatory Authority, Egypt, Mr. Toshiyuki Miyoshi, Vice Minister for International Affairs, Financial Services Agency, Japan, Mr. Mark T. Uyeda, Commissioner, US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and Mr. Grant Vingo, Chief Executive Officer, Ontario Securities Commission (OSC) are Vice-Chairs of the IOSCO Board.
4. The Growth and Emerging Markets (GEM) Committee is the largest Committee within IOSCO, representing more than 75% of the IOSCO membership, including ten of the G20 members. The Committee unites members from growth and emerging markets and communicates their views at other global regulatory discussions. It is chaired by Dr. Islam Azzam, Executive Chairman, Financial Regulatory Authority, Egypt.
5. IOSCO counts four regional committees: (1) Africa / Middle-East (AMERC), chaired by H.E. Waleed Saeed Al Awadhi, Chief Executive Officer, Securities and Commodities Authority, United Arab Emirates; (2) Asia & Pacific (APRC), chaired by Ms. Julia Leung, Chief Executive Officer of the Hong-Kong Securities and Futures Commission; (3) European Regional Committee (ERC), chaired by Mr.

Jean-Paul Servais; and (4) Inter-American Regional Committee (IARC), chaired by Ms. Christina Rolle, Executive Director, Securities Commission of The Bahamas.

6. IOSCO's General Secretariat is headquartered in Madrid, Spain. The Secretariat supports and coordinates the work of IOSCO and is comprised of permanent staff and member secondees. It is led by Rodrigo Buenaventura who was appointed IOSCO's Secretary General in January 2025.

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